

Conclusions - Workbook 2

Apply supported generalizations to new but related situations.

Strategy reminder

Combine several details, then control scope. The best conclusion is broad enough to explain the pattern but narrow enough to remain supported.

After-School Tutoring

Text 1

A tutoring program compared three schedules. Group 1 attended one 90-minute session each week. Group 2 attended three 30-minute sessions. Group 3 attended five 18-minute sessions. All groups received the same total weekly time. After six weeks, Groups 2 and 3 completed more practice problems between sessions and showed more consistent gains on weekly quizzes than Group 1.

1. Which conclusion is best supported?

- A. Shorter, more frequent sessions were associated with more consistent progress in this program
- B. Ninety-minute sessions never help any student
- C. Group 3 will always outperform Group 2
- D. Total tutoring time does not matter

2. Which new situation best illustrates the same idea?

- A. A musician practices fifteen minutes on several days instead of one long weekly session and tracks steady improvement
- B. A musician changes instruments every day
- C. A teacher removes all practice
- D. A student buys a new music stand

Repair Before Replace

Text 2

A housing office tested a repair-first policy for damaged desks. During the first month, technicians repaired 68 percent of reported desks and replaced the rest. The average cost per case fell, but repair requests took one day longer to close. Residents rated repaired desks about the same as replacement desks. The office kept the policy but added a rule allowing immediate replacement when a safety problem was involved.

3. Which conclusion is best supported?

- A. Repair-first reduced costs but required a tradeoff in completion time
- B. Repair is always safer than replacement
- C. Residents disliked every repaired desk
- D. Replacement should never be allowed

4. Which generalization best fits the office's final policy?

- A. A general rule can include exceptions when a different priority becomes more important
- B. Rules should never change
- C. Cost should always matter more than safety
- D. Every damaged item should be repaired

Reading Nook

Text 3

A library converted an unused corner into a reading nook with soft chairs. Use of the area increased, but noise complaints from nearby study tables also increased. The library added two low dividers and moved the noisiest chair away from the tables. Use remained high while complaints fell.

5. Which conclusion is best supported?

- A. The library improved the space by adjusting the design rather than removing the popular feature
- B. Soft chairs always cause noise

- C. The reading nook should be closed
- D. Dividers eliminate every sound

6. Which new situation best illustrates the same principle?

- A. A park keeps a popular picnic area but adds barriers to protect nearby plants
- B. A store removes its most popular product immediately
- C. A school ignores a problem because a program is popular
- D. A cafe changes its logo

Review your reasoning

Before checking the key, mark the question that felt hardest. Write one clue that changed your mind and name the distractor that was most tempting.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A - The conclusion describes the pattern without making a universal claim.
Watch for: Keep the conclusion inside the study context.
2. A - The new situation preserves the pattern of distributed repeated practice.
Watch for: Generalize the structure of the learning pattern.
3. A - The passage combines lower cost with slightly longer resolution time.
Watch for: Strong conclusions keep important tradeoffs.
4. A - The policy keeps repair-first but makes an exception for safety.
Watch for: Abstract the principle from the specific desk example.
5. A - The final design preserved use while reducing the problem.
Watch for: Look across the before-and-after pattern.
6. A - The park preserves the valued use while reducing a side effect.
Watch for: Match the balance-and-adjust principle.